

TITLE: Client Onboarding Standard Operating Procedure

ORGANIZATION: Northwind Analytics, Inc.

DEPARTMENT: Operations

SENSITIVITY: Internal

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Client Onboarding Standard Operating Procedure

This SOP defines the standard process for onboarding a new client engagement, applicable to both IT Services delivery engagements and Manufacturing supply contracts.

1. Pre-Engagement (Day -14 to Day -1)

- Sales hands off signed contract and Statement of Work (SOW) to the Client Onboarding team.
- Legal confirms contract execution and flags any non-standard terms to Delivery leadership.
- Finance sets up the client billing account and confirms payment terms in the ERP system.
- For Manufacturing clients: Supply Chain confirms production capacity allocation and initial material forecast.

2. Kickoff (Day 1-5)

- Assign a named Client Success Manager (CSM) as the client's single point of contact.
- Conduct a kickoff call within 5 business days of contract execution, covering scope, timeline, communication cadence, and escalation contacts.
- Provision any required system access (client portal accounts, shared workspaces) within 3 business days of kickoff.

3. 30-Day Health Check

The CSM conducts a formal check-in at 30 days to confirm the engagement is tracking to plan, address any early friction points, and confirm the client's satisfaction with onboarding before transitioning to standard account management cadence.

4. Escalation

Onboarding delays exceeding 5 business days against the plan must be escalated to the Delivery Director, with a recovery plan documented within 2 business days of escalation.